

childishly simple but feel sorrow for the wasted potential of the game; one who will accept Crysis 3 as a visual masterpiece but also as a study in flawed game design. A real gamer is one who will feel a cold chill traveling up his spine when game designers talk about making a game more “accessible” and shudder at the thought of Free2Play becoming the norm. The true gamer will derive as much pleasure from Mario and Minesweeper as he will from Half-Life and Quake.

Selling out

When gaming just started picking up almost 20 years ago, it was still in its infancy. Big name developers were just starting out and companies such as Sierra, Valve, Novalogic, etc. were coming up big time. As with any major corporation, their primary focus was to make money, but, thankfully, at the time, gamers were a niche audience and these companies were trying to sell their games to this audience. What would those gamers want? Good games, and that’s what they got.

This was a time when excellent game design was directly tied to the amount of money that was to be made and companies could encourage artists to create the games of their dreams. Those years saw the birth of some of the most epic titles we’ve ever seen, including such classics as Age of Empires, Half-Life, the original Delta Force, etc. Excellent game design is still tied to money these days as well, but it is an increasingly rare occurrence and game designers seem to just be hunting for the perfect “formula” that will help



Few have the willpower to ignore such visions

them churn out games that make them piles and piles of money. The focus is the money, not the game. The audience has also expanded to include literally

everyone and as a result the average skill level of a gamer fell drastically. This drastic drop in skill level has also resulted in game franchises like Assassin’s Creed and Call of Duty. We’re not saying that these are bad games; it’s just that they’re targeting a different level of gamer and not the type this story is aimed at.



Big companies require big bucks to survive

Developers of the first kind

There are essentially three primary types of game developers. The first is the large corporation (such as EA and Activision) that try to make a lot of money by making a game that is popular and accessible. This type of developer has a lot of money, conducts a lot of research, knows its audience and produces a technically



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